

HORMUZ TRANSITS	BAB EL-MANDEB	PANAMA CANAL	SCFI COMPOSITE	BRENT CRUDE	VLSFO SINGAPORE	ORDER BOOK / FLEET	SCHEDULED RELIABILITY
4	33	32	1,954	\$107.66	\$715	23.4%	54%
vessels yesterday	vessels/day	vessels/day	▲ +45%	▲	▲ +\$35	Peak deliveries	▼ -9pts
· 7d MA: ~6	7d MA	7d MA	YoY · May 13	+3.21% · May 12	since Apr 24 · May 13	Q3-Q4	from Jan '26
vs 96/day pre-crisis · -96% · Day 74	vs ~56/day pre-Houthi · -41%	vs 36/day capacity · 87% · ENSO watch	Trading Economics · +3.4% MoM	close +49.5% vs pre-crisis · Hormuz Day 74	Est. from Brent · Rotterdam ~\$695 cheapest	Blank sailing discipline critical	Apr '26 · Gemini best at 74%

LIVE INTELLIGENCE FEED — TOP 10 STORIES TODAY

TOP 10 NEWS — CONTAINER SHIPPING INTELLIGENCE

13 MAY 2026

01

GEOPOLITICS

Trump meets Xi in China this week — Hochstein: "no war, no oil, no straits condition" · Brent \$107.77 close May 12 · ceasefire on "massive life support"

CNBC / Trading Economics · May 12–13, 2026

↳ Trump-Xi meeting is the week's key diplomatic event. Oil prices forecast at \$90–\$100/bbl range through year-end even if Hormuz reopens in early June (Hochstein). Binary outcome for global energy and freight markets.

02

GEOPOLITICS

Saudi Aramco CEO: market losing ~100M bbl/week — if Hormuz stays shut past mid-June, market normalisation delayed to 2027

CNBC / Saudi Aramco Q1 earnings call · May 11, 2026

↳ Aramco framing the mid-June deadline is the most important supply signal this week. If Trump-Xi produces no result, begin modelling 2027 normalisation scenario for fleet, contract, and bunker planning.

CUSTOMER CHURN RISK RADAR

V4

SEGMENT RISK · CURRENT CYCLE

ME/Gulf importers	Critical
Asia-Europe shippers	Med
Intra-Asia SME	Med
Trans-Pac BCOs	Low
Latin America routes	Low

↳ SO WHAT

ME/Gulf customers face forced rerouting — proactive engagement critical. Trans-Pac BCOs locked in on strong demand.

03 RATES

Container spot rates rebound +3% WoW — WCI \$2,286/40ft · MSC raises EFS to \$644/FEU Asia-USEC · CMA CGM launches Africa PSS

[gCaptain](#) / [Drewry WCI](#) · May 8, 2026

↳ Rebound driven by surcharges not demand. Carriers stacking EFS + PSS + GRI on top of base rates. Overcapacity and soft demand are counterweights — rate increases not fully sticking on east-west lanes.

04 SECURITY

CMA CGM San Antonio attacked in Hormuz · HMM vessel hull hit twice May 4 · Chinese tanker JV Innovation first Chinese vessel targeted May 7

[Seatrade Maritime](#) / [Container News](#) · May 4–10, 2026

↳ Chinese vessel targeting is a major escalation — China had been the one flag state with near-routine transit authorisation. Watch for Beijing's response and any change in IRGC posture toward Chinese carriers.

05 OPERATIONS

Iran establishes Persian Gulf Strait Authority (May 5) to regulate transit — Operation Project Freedom paused May 6 after "great progress" claim

[Wikipedia](#) / [CNBC](#) · May 5–6, 2026

↳ Iran's new Strait Authority is a sovereignty assertion that institutionalises Hormuz control. Pausing Project Freedom was a concession but Hormuz remains shut. This is a new regime, not a temporary closure.

06 SUPPLY CHAIN

DHL: 4–6 months to normalisation · Singapore-Jebel Ali rates quadrupled to \$8,000+/container · port congestion at Jeddah, Khorfakkan, Sohar, Fujairah

[Carra Globe](#) / [DHL Global Forwarding](#) / [Freightos](#) · May 10, 2026

↳ Gulf container trade in severe distress. Saudi Yanbu pipeline route (Red Sea) partially absorbing Gulf energy cargo but capacity-limited. Plan for 4–6 month disruption as operational baseline.

07 CAPACITY

OOCL names world's largest methanol dual-fuel container ship — Brazil clears shipping lines to bid for Santos mega terminal

[Seatrade Maritime](#) · May 12, 2026

↳ OOCL methanol naming signals dual-fuel fleet transition accelerating among top carriers. Brazil Santos terminal bid opening is a significant Latin America port investment opportunity.

	Windward AI · JMIC · Chokepoints
	Oil / FRED/EIA · IMF PortWatch
	Bunker · Ship&Bunker · Argus
	Fleet / Clarksons · Capacity · Alphaliner
	Port / PMSA · Drewry · Ops · MDS
	Charter · New ConTex (VHBS) · Mkt · MSI
	FRED · Census API · Macro/Trade · ISM · NBS

DATA CADENCE

[Oil \(FRED\)](#): Daily · [Bunker](#)
([Ship&Bunker](#)): Daily
[Chokepoints \(PortWatch\)](#): Weekly
[Tue](#)
[SCFI / Rates](#): Weekly [Fri](#)
[Charter \(ConTex\)](#): Weekly [Thu](#)
[PMI / Consumer](#): Monthly
[News \(RSS\)](#): Hourly

BUNKER

Bunker fuel supply in Asian hubs tightening — carriers adding \$200–\$500/container EFS · availability in Singapore under increasing pressure

↳ Bunker availability becoming a supply security issue, not just a price issue. Pre-book bunker at Cape waypoints (Durban, Las Palmas) — don't rely on Singapore spot availability.

REGULATORY

MSC and CMA CGM announce new Emergency Fuel
Surcharges across multiple trade lanes — Freight All Kinds rates
\$3,500–\$4,500/FEU announced for Asia-N.Europe

↳ FAK rate announcements of \$3,500–\$4,500/FEU on Asia-N.Europe are aggressive. Watch how much sticks vs slips — overcapacity and shipper resistance are the limiting factors.

MARKET OUTLOOK

SCFI 1,954 on May 13 (+45.3% YoY) · Polymarket: 67.5% probability Hormuz stays below 60 transits/day through end-June · Goldman: Brent averaging \$100+ in Q2

↳ Market pricing a prolonged crisis. SCFI breaking above 2,000 would signal contract renegotiation cycle. Watch Trump-Xi outcome this week as the most significant near-term catalyst for either direction.

GEOPOLITICAL RISK & MACRO TRADE SIGNALS

GEOPOLITICAL RISK MONITOR		GLOBAL TRADE VOLUME SIGNALS		STRATEGIC SCENARIO — 90-DAY OUTLOOK	
	RISK		DEMAND		OUTLOOK
Strait of Hormuz Crisis	9.8	CONTAINER THROUGHPUT YOY % · APR 2026		RATE ENVIRONMENT PROBABILITY	
Red Sea / Houthi	8.8			RALLY ELEVATED SOFTEN COLLAPSE	
US-China Trade War	8.0			20%	45%
Taiwan Strait	6.0			25%	10%
Europe Port Labour	5.0			KEY DECISION TRIGGERS	
Panama Canal (El Niño)	3.5	Far East → N. America	+8.2%	Trump-Xi meeting this week — deal progress → Brent −10–15%; breakdown → Brent toward \$115–\$125 · Aramco: mid-June deadline for 2027 normalisation ⚡ THIS WEEK · MONITOR DAILY	
		Far East → Europe	+4.1%		
		Asia → ME / India	+1.8% ↓ Hormuz impact		
		Asia → Latin America	+6.8%		
		Intra-Asia	−1.4%		
		China Mfg PMI	51.4	USTR China vessel fee decision —	

as the indefinite baseline.

(Apr)



Baltic Dry
Index

~1,840



US Consumer
Confidence

104.2



SO WHAT

Latin America unaffected by current crisis — structural growth corridor. Asia-ME suppressed by Hormuz closure despite underlying demand. Trans-Pac demand supported by tariff front-loading + US consumer confidence.

fundamentally reshapes alliance vessel deployment if enacted · Consultation closed

DECISION: IMMINENT · JUN 2026

H2 2026 newbuild delivery peak — blank sailing coordination critical to prevent rate floor collapse

PEAK: AUG–NOV 2026

Panama El Niño Watch — NOAA Apr 2026 · ~25% chance of strong event compressing Canal slots

MONITOR MONTHLY

ENERGY PRICES — CRUDE OIL & BUNKER · AS OF MAY 12–13, 2026

**BRENT
CRUDE (ICE) ·
MAY 12
CLOSE ·
STRAITS.LIVE
/ TRADING
ECONOMICS**

\$107.66

/bbl

▲ +3.21% ·
+\$3.36 vs May
11

+49.5% vs pre-
crisis ~\$72 · 52-
wk range \$58.50–
\$126 · Aramco:
100M bbl/week
demand
destruction

**WTI CRUDE
(NYMEX) · MAY
13 INTRADAY ·
INVESTING.COM**

\$101.38 /bbl

▲ +3.38% today ·
range \$98.02–
\$102.03

Brent-WTI spread
~\$5.58 · 52-wk
range \$54.98–
\$117.63 · +60% YoY

**VLSFO
SINGAPORE ·
MAY 13 EST. ·
SHIP&BUNKER**

\$715 /MT

▲ +\$35 since Apr
24 · est. from
Brent

MGO est.
~\$1,220/MT ·
Fujairah supply
very tight ·
Rotterdam ~\$695
(cheapest) ·
Bunker availability
tightening in Asian
hubs

CEO ENERGY BRIEFING — APR 24

Brent at **\$107.66/bbl (May 12 close)** — Day 74 of Hormuz closure. Trump meets Xi in China this week; Hochstein calls it a "no war, no oil, no straits condition." Saudi Aramco CEO Nasser warns the market is losing **~100M bbl/week** and normalization could slip to 2027 if Hormuz stays shut past mid-June. WTI at \$101.38, up +60% YoY. Operation Project Freedom (US Navy escort) paused May 6. Iran's new Persian Gulf Strait Authority (est. May 5) now controls who transits. VLSFO est. \$715/MT. War-risk insurance for VLCCs at **~\$2.5M per transit (up 1,900%)**. 6 P&I clubs have withdrawn Gulf coverage. **Hedge book must remain live — binary risk on Xi-Trump outcome this week.**

GLOBAL BUNKERING PRICES — 13 MAJOR PORTS · SHIP&BUNKER · MAY 13, 2026

PORT-BY-PORT BUNKER PRICE MONITOR (\$/MT)

EST. MAY 13 · SHIP&BUNKER

✓ **CHEAPEST VLSFO · MAY 13**
Rotterdam est. ~\$695/MT

~\$20 cheaper than Singapore · Save ~\$120K on 6,000MT stem

FUJAIRAH · MAY 13

VERY TIGHT — Day 74

Est. \$730/MT · bunker availability tightening in Asian hubs · 6 P&I clubs withdrawn coverage

ASIAN HUB AVAILABILITY · MAY 13

Tightening — EFS stacking

Carriers adding \$200–\$500/container EFS · Bunker availability in Singapore under pressure

Port	VLSFO 0.5%S	Δ WoW	HSFO 3.5%S	MGO 0.1%S	MGO- VLSFO	Availability
ASIA-PACIFIC · Prices est. May 13, 2026						
 Singapore #1 global · availability tightening	est. \$715	▲ est. +\$35 since Apr 24	\$620	\$1,178	+\$498	Good
 Zhoushan East China Sea	\$668	▲ +\$11 (+1.7%)	\$605	\$1,165	+\$497	Good
 Busan NE Asia · Trans-Pac hub	\$695	▲ +\$9 (+1.3%)	\$624	\$1,192	+\$497	Good
MIDDLE EAST · Prices est. May 13, 2026 — CRISIS DAY 74						
 Fujairah #3 global · Very tight supply · Day 74	est. \$730	▲ est. +\$40 since Apr 24	\$620	\$1,334	+\$644	TIGHT
EUROPE · Prices est. May 13, 2026						
 Rotterdam ★ Cheapest N. Europe · biofuel hub	est. \$695	▲ est. +\$31 since Apr 24	\$591	\$1,149	+\$485	Good
 Antwerp RED III B24 biofuel hub	\$668	▲ +\$5 (+0.8%)	\$593	\$1,152	+\$484	Good
 Gibraltar Med gateway · Cape waypoint	\$678	▲ +\$8 (+1.2%)	\$601	\$1,161	+\$483	Good
AMERICAS · Prices est. May 13, 2026						
 Houston US Gulf Coast	\$809	▲ +\$2.50 (+0.3%)	\$615	\$1,112	+\$303	Good
 LA / Long Beach USWC · most expensive	\$954	▲ +\$12.50 (+1.3%)	\$804	\$1,468	+\$514	Good

today						
 Santos Latin America ·  WoW surge	\$683	▲ +\$66 (+10.7%) 	\$619	\$1,440	+\$757	Tight
CAPE ROUTE WAYPOINTS · Prices est. May 13, 2026 — Demand surge from rerouting						
 Durban Cape of Good Hope route	\$671	▲ +\$14 (+2.1%)	\$601	\$1,148	+\$477	Busy
 Las Palmas Canary Islands · N. waypoint	\$669	▲ +\$11 (+1.7%)	\$598	\$1,145	+\$476	Busy

EU ETS CARBON COST ADD-ON — PER MT BURNED ON EU VOYAGES (100% PHASE-IN 2026)

EUA Price · May 13

€68.40

per tonne CO₂

VLSFO add-on

+\$218/MT

3.18 tCO₂/MT

MGO add-on

+\$209/MT

3.06 tCO₂/MT

True VLSFO cost (EU)

~\$882/MT

Rotterdam + EUA

 EU ETS at 100% for intra-EU voyages and 50% for extra-EU legs in 2026. The berth bunker price alone is NOT the full cost on EU routes — include EUA in all voyage economics.

GREEN & ALTERNATIVE FUELS — AVAILABILITY & PRICE · MAY 13, 2026 (EST.)

Bio-Methanol

Singapore · Rotterdam

\$1,240 /MT

▼ -\$15 WoW · narrowing

Premium vs VLSFO: +\$576/MT

LNG Bunker

Rotterdam · Singapore · Houston

\$890 /MT eq.

▲ +\$22 WoW

Premium vs VLSFO: +\$226/MT

B24 Biofuel

Singapore only

\$812 /MT

→ Stable

Premium vs VLSFO: +\$132/MT

Green NH₃ (est.)

Very limited

\$2,100 /MT eq.

→ Stable
Premium vs VLSFO: +\$1,420/MT

SO WHAT — BUNKERING STRATEGY

Rotterdam cheapest at \$664/MT — saves ~\$96K on a 6,000MT stem vs LA/LB. **Fujairah tight** — shift planning to Singapore or pre-bunker where voyage allows. **Santos +\$66/MT** — investigate before LATAM calls. **Cape waypoints Durban/Las Palmas** — pre-book supply; don't assume spot. **EU ETS reality:** Rotterdam true cost ~\$882/MT incl. EUA — fundamentally changes EU voyage economics.

Source: Ship&Bunker · Integr8 Fuels ENGINE · MABUX · EU ETS Registry

REGULATORY HORIZON & SUSTAINABILITY

REGULATORY HORIZON

CRITICAL

 **IMO FuelEU Maritime — Active**
2% GHG intensity reduction active from Jan 2025; 6% from 2030. Cape rerouting worsening fleet CII. Non-compliance pooling penalties now a real cost.
ACTIVE · ONGOING

 **EU ETS Phase 2 — Shipping**
100% intra-EU inclusion; 50% extra-EU legs. EUA at €68.40/tonne. Q3 surrender deadline — verify EUA position immediately.
DEADLINE: 30 SEPT 2026

 **USTR Chinese-Built Vessel Fee**
\$1M+ per US port call for Chinese-built/flagged vessels. If enacted, fundamental fleet restructure required. Consultation closes May 2026.
DECISION: MAY–JUNE 2026

 **IMO GHG Mid-Term Measures**
Carbon levy proposals at MEPC 83. Net-zero 2050 pathway — critical for current newbuild fuel decisions and fleet investment planning horizon.
MEPC 83 · OCT 2026

CARBON INTENSITY (CII) BY ROUTE

FLEET

CII RATING — LOWER = BETTER · APR 2026

Trans-Pacific	A
Asia-Europe	B
Cape Rerouting	C+
Intra-Asia	B
Middle East	D

EU ETS EUA (€/tCO₂) · Apr 24 **€68.40**

Fleet avg CII rating **B+ / C risk**

SO WHAT

Cape rerouting degrading fleet CII to C/D — EU ETS penalties accelerate from 2027. Plan fleet trajectory now. Bio-methanol spread narrowing to VLSFO — watch tipping point economics for newbuild fuel choice decisions in 2026 for 2028–30 positioning.

GLOBAL CHOKEPOINT DAILY TRANSITS — IMF PORTWATCH · LAST UPDATED: TUE MAY 12, 2026

 **STRAIT OF HORMUZ**

CLOSED — DAY 74

YESTERDAY (MAY 12)
4
vessels/day

7-DAY MA
~6
vessels/day

PRE-WAR AVG
100
vessels/day

 **BAB EL-MANDEB DISRUPTED**

7D MA (WK APR 22)
33
vessels/day

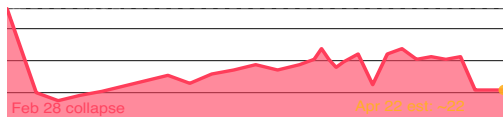
WEEKLY AVG
33
vessels/day

PRE-HOUTH AVG
56
vessels/day

 **PANAMA CANAL**

7D MA (WK APR 22)
32

W
ves



Feb 28 Mar 15 Apr 17 CF May 4 PF May 12: 4

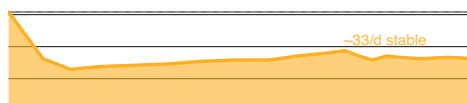
Latest vs Pre-War Avg **-78%**

7d MA vs Pre-War Avg **-89%**

SO WHAT

4 transits yesterday (May 12) per IMF PortWatch — 96% below pre-crisis baseline of ~96/day. 7d MA ~6/day. Polymarket: 67.5% probability Hormuz stays below 60/day through end-June. Operation Project Freedom (US Navy escort) paused May 6. Iran's new Persian Gulf Strait Authority est. May 5 — only Chinese-flagged vessels receiving routine authorisation. Trump-Xi meeting this week could be pivotal. Aramco: if closed past mid-June, normalization shifts to 2027. AIS spoofing and GPS jamming ongoing — IMF PortWatch flagging data quality issues. Cape routing is the only operational default.

IMF PortWatch (last: Tue May 12) · straits.live · Polymarket prediction market · JMIC · Wikipedia 2026 Hormuz crisis



Nov '23 Jan '24 Jun '24 Jan '25 Apr '26

vs Pre-Houthi Avg **-41%**

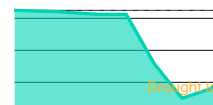
7d MA vs Avg **-41%**

SO WHAT

Stable at ~33/day since late 2024. Iran threatened to extend blockade to Bab el-Mandeb if Hormuz talks fail. Simultaneous closure of both straits = ~30% of global container shipping blocked — a \$10B/day trade-at-risk scenario.

IMF PortWatch (last: Tue May 12) · Seatrade Maritime · freightos.com market update

vessels/day



Jul '23 Nov '23 F

vs Full Capacity

vs Pre-Drought Avg

SO WHAT

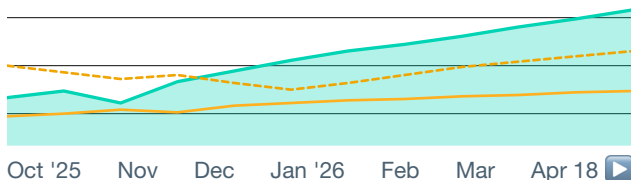
Fully recovered from 87% of historical capacity. Watch issued April of strong event by compress slots again monthly.

IMF PortWatch · Panama Canal Authority

MARKET & FREIGHT RATES · SCFI 1,954 · WCI \$2,286 · MAY 13, 2026

SPOT RATE INDEX — KEY TRADE LANES (SCFI \$/TEU)

MAY 9 PUB · WCI MAY 8



— Trans-Pacific (+45% YoY · WCI \$3,062 LA) - - Asia-Europe — Intra-Asia

SO WHAT

WCI composite +3% WoW to \$2,286/40ft. Trans-Pac driven by carrier EFS stacking — MSC raised Asia-USEC EFS to \$644/FEU, USWC to \$467/FEU. Singapore-Jebel Ali quadrupled to \$8,000+/container since war began. Asia-Europe firming (+2% WoW). Rate on booking is not the full cost — EFS, war-risk and PSS stacking.

ROUTE RATE DASHBOARD

MAY 9 PUB · WCI MAY 8

ROUTE	\$/TEU	WOW	STATUS
Shanghai → LA Trans-Pac West	\$3,062	+5.0% WoW	▲ Rising
Shanghai → Rotterdam Asia-Europe	\$2,170	+2.0% WoW	▲ Firming
Shanghai → NY Trans-Atlantic	\$3,721	+7.0% WoW	▲ Strong
Sgp → Jeddah	\$8,000+	+4x since	

Overcapacity acting as counterweight to fuel-cost pressure on east-west lanes (Freightos). Model 15–20% spot correction across all lanes the day Hormuz reopens.

Middle East		Feb 28	▼ Quadrupled
Intra-Asia	\$880	–3.8%	▼ Weak
Regional			

FLEET OPERATIONS, NETWORK & RELIABILITY

PORT CONGESTION

4-HLY

(DWEELL DAYS)

ASIA-PACIFIC

Shanghai	1.2d
Singapore	1.6d
Port Klang	3.8d

EUROPE / US

Rotterdam	2.1d
LA / Long Beach	5.4d
Savannah	3.6d

SO WHAT

LA/LB at 5.4d — tariff front-loading effect. Rail dwell improved to 4.4d (vs 6.8d YoY). Buffer vessel positioning on Trans-Pac loops advised.

FLEET UTILISATION

FLEET

BY TRADE

Trans-Pacific	94%
Trans-Atlantic	91%
Asia-Europe	86%
Middle East	62%
Intra-Asia	72%

Fleet-wide average 87.4%

Blank sailings 34
YTD sailings

SCHEDULE RELIABILITY

APR 2026

BY ALLIANCE

ON-TIME PERFORMANCE % · APR 2026

Gemini	74%
Premier	58%
MSC Solo	51%
Ocean Allnc	48%

Industry avg Apr '26 54%
vs Jan '26 ▼ –9pts

SO WHAT

Gemini's +20pt reliability lead vs industry avg is now a shipper procurement differentiator. Reliability rivals price in contract negotiations.

CARBON INTENSITY

FLEE

(CII) BY ROUTE

CII RATING — LO' BETTER

Trans-Pacific
Asia-Europe
Cape Rerouting
Intra-Asia
Middle East

EU ETS EUA (€/tCO₂) Apr 24

Fleet avg CII rating B

CAPACITY, SUPPLY, COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE & CHARTER MARKET

INDUSTRY ORDER BOOK

RISK

23.4%

OF EXISTING FLEET · TEU · CLARKSONS

Total on order	5.8M TEU
2026 deliveries	2.1M TEU
Methanol/LNG orders	41%
18,000+ TEU	62

ALLIANCE & MARKET SHARE · ALPHALINER

INTEL

MSC	
Solo · 6M+ TEU · liner-owned fleet	19.2% ▲ +0.4% YoY
64%	
Maersk	
Gemini	15.6%

M&A ACTIVITY WATCHLIST

INTEL

LIVE

Hapag-Lloyd acquires ZIM — \$4.2B \$35/share (58% premium). Creates 3M TEU / 400-vessel fleet. Workers striking over labour terms. New ZIM Israeli entity via

NEWBUILD VS S&P SPREAD

S&P MKT

VESSEL VALUES (\$M) · CLARKSONS APR 2026

NB 14,000 TEU	\$178M
S&P 14k TEU (5yr)	\$134M
NB Premium	+33%
NB 8,000 TEU	\$108M
S&P 8k TEU (5yr)	\$89M
NB Premium	+21%
Yard slot	2028–

↳ **SO WHAT**

H2 2026 delivery peak threatens rate recovery. Blank sailing coordination is the key lever. Drewry: charter rate correction likely 2027 as 2.8M TEU deliveries arrive. Scrapping near zero (6,900 TEU in H1 '25) — no natural fleet relief.

2	Ally	▼ -0.8% YoY
	Ally (w/ Hapag)	
	CMA CGM	
3	Premier Alliance	12.8% ▲ +0.2%
	MAX service	
	COSCO / OOCL	11.1% → Stable
4	Premier Alliance	
	Hapag + ZIM	
5	\$4.2B deal	~9.2% ⚡ M&A
	close late 2026	

HIMI PE. Close: late 2026.

WATCH Terminal operator consolidation COSCO & CMA CGM expanding terminal equity globally. Watch PSA & DP World responses to carrier-owned terminal strategy escalation.

availability 29 5yr-old vs NB ratio 80% — highest since '22

↳ **SO WHAT**

33% NB premium + yards booked to 2028 make S&P secondhand the faster capacity route. Active S&P market signals bullish sentiment. Scrapping near zero — no organic fleet relief for 2026–27.

WATCH Mid-tier carrier vulnerability Evergreen, ONE, Yang Ming under pressure as top-3 scale diverges. Next wave likely targets 500k–1M TEU operators by 2027–28.

↳ **SO WHAT**

Industry consolidating toward 4–5 mega-carriers. M&A positioning conversations needed in next 18 months. ZIM deal gives Hapag 40% LNG-fuelled fleet advantage and premium e-commerce network.

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Vessel Size	Charter Period	Rate \$/Day	vs 2019 Pre-Pandemic	YoY Change	Market Signal
1,000–1,100 TEU Feeder Short-sea / intra-Asia · New ConTex	6 months	\$16,750	+140%	▲ +8% YoY	Resilient — low new supply sub-3k TEU
2,100 TEU Feeder Regional / feeder hub · MSI data	12 months	\$30,100	+200%	▲ +1.4% MoM	Strong — feeder market tight
4,250 TEU Classic Panamax New ConTex · 12-month charter	12 months	\$54,500	+200%	▲ +0.7% MoM	Watch — long-term extensions at \$35k/d
7,000+ TEU Post-Panamax Spot market · Clarksons Jan '26	3–6 months spot	\$100,000+	+350%+	▲ Six-figure rates	Extreme scarcity — Maersk fixing \$100k/d short-term
New ConTex Composite Hamburg/Bremen Shipbrokers · published Thu	Mix	+11% YTD 2026	+200% vs 2019	Trebled vs early 2024	Strongest sustained boom outside 2021–22 Covid peak

└ SO WHAT — CHARTER STRATEGY

Charter rates 200% above 2019 with Drewry forecasting a correction in 2027 as 2.8M TEU newbuilds deliver. If charters expire in 2026, re-fixing now locks in elevated rates while possible. Feeder market most resilient — minimal new supply through 2026 H1. Avoid spot for large vessels at \$100k+/day — prioritise long-term fix or own. MSC's move to 64% owned fleet (vs 54% in 2019) is reducing market liquidity for non-operating owners.

 Source: New ConTex (VHBS Hamburg/Bremen Shipbrokers) · Weekly Thursday · MSI Container Shipping Review · Drewry Container Forecaster · Clarksons Containership Time Charter Rate Index

DEMAND LEADING INDICATORS & CHINA+1 TRADE SHIFT — 6–10 WEEK FORWARD SIGNAL

MACRO LEADING INDICATORS — FORWARD DEMAND SIGNAL

Trade Volumes

US Imports YoY · Mar

+7.2%

US Retail Sales MoM · Mar

+0.4%

Global Port TEU Index · Apr

+4.1% YoY

Forward bookings · VIZION Apr

+6.1% WoW

FRED · US Census API (free public)

V5 · FRED/ISM/NBS

CHINA+1 TRADE SHIFT — US IMPORT ORIGIN (YOY %) · CENSUS API

V5 · MAR 2026

US IMPORT VOLUME BY ORIGIN COUNTRY — YOY CHANGE · MAR 2026

▲ GAINING SHARE



Vietnam

+18.3%



Mexico

+12.1%



Manufacturing PMI

China Mfg (NBS) · Apr

51.4 ▲

US ISM Mfg · Apr

49.0 ▼

Eurozone PMI · Apr

47.6 ▼

India Mfg PMI · Apr

57.4 ▲

NBS · ISM · S&P Global Markit

Consumer Confidence

US Conf. Board · Apr

104.2 ▲

EU Consumer Sentiment · Apr

-14.2

China Consumer Conf. · Mar

87.4

US Savings Rate · Mar

3.8%

FRED · Conference Board · Monthly

Market Signals

Baltic Dry Index · Apr 24

~1,840 ▲

Baltic Tanker BDTI

↑ Hormuz premium

SCFI vs FBX divergence

Watch

ConTex index · Apr 24

+11% YTD

Stooq BDI CSV · VHBS · All free APIs

↳ SO WHAT

India PMI 57.4 and US consumer confidence 104.2 are the strongest forward signals — support Trans-Pac and SE Asia feeder demand for next 6–10 weeks. EU PMI at 47.6 (contraction) signals softening Asia-Europe demand through Q2. China PMI barely expansionary — tariff diversion to SE Asia is structural, not cyclical. US ISM at 49.0 is a near-term caution signal for US import demand.

India

+9.2%



Bangladesh

+8.6%



Indonesia

+7.4%



Thailand

+6.8%

▼ LOSING SHARE



China

-8.4%



Germany

-3.1%



Japan

-1.8%



South Korea

-1.2%

SE Asia feeder capacity undersupplied relative to structural demand growth — Vietnam/Indonesia/Bangladesh shipping demand growing 7–18% YoY. Priority network expansion opportunity for 2026–28.

STRATEGIC · 2026–28

Mexico nearshoring driving Latin America corridor growth — assess whether current LATAM service frequency matches demand trajectory.

WATCH · 2026

China volume decline (-8.4%) is structural not cyclical. China+1 accelerating across all major BCO sectors. Network design decisions must reflect this shift permanently.

STRUCTURAL · MULTI-YEAR

 US Census Bureau Foreign Trade API (free) · UN Comtrade API · World Bank trade data

SEALENS V5 — DATA PROVENANCE & UPDATE CADENCE

Refreshed May 13, 2026:

Brent \$107.66 (May 12

close) · WTI \$101.38 ·

Hormuz 4 transits

Price Date Stamps: [Brent](#):

\$107.66 (May 12 close ·

[straits.live](#) / [Trading](#)

Economics) · WTI: \$101.38

Checkpoint Note: [IMF](#)

[PortWatch](#) data is updated

weekly each Tuesday.

Hormuz estimates also

V6 Roadmap: [Voyage](#)

[economics P&L calculator](#)

(live route cost model) · [AI](#)

CEO daily narrative brief

yesterday (–96%) · SCFI
1,954 (+45% YoY) · WCI
\$2,286 (+3% WoW) · 10
new news stories ·
Singapore-Jebel Ali rates
quadrupled to \$8,000+ ·
Trump-Xi meeting flagged
as key catalyst · Bunker
estimates updated from
Brent · All price date
stamps updated

(May 13 intraday ·
Investing.com) · SCFI:
1,954 (May 13 · Trading
Economics) · WCI: \$2,286
(May 8 pub ·
gCaptain/Drewry) · Bunker:
estimated May 13 from
Brent differential ·
Chokepoints: IMF
PortWatch (last updated
Tue May 12) · Note: IMF
flagging AIS data quality
issues due to GPS jamming
near Hormuz

incorporate JMIC
advisories and
MarineTraffic/CNBC
reporting as spot
verification. AIS spoofing
near Hormuz means official
counts may understate
actual traffic — treat as
directional indicators, not
precise daily counts.

(Claude API, ~\$0.02/brief) ·
Xeneta contract vs spot
gap monitor (subscription) ·
AIS anomaly/shadow fleet
alerts (Windward AI) ·
Green corridor certification
per vessel (IMO GISIS API)
· Transit count push alerts
(Hormuz <10 →
notification)

